MATA Matrimony — Competitive Battle Card

> ***Purpose:*** *Sales & product reference for understanding how MATA Matrimony compares to leading matrimony platforms.*
> ***Competitors:*** *Shaadi.com · BharatMatrimony · Jeevansathi*
> ***Version:*** *V1.0 — March 2026*
> ***Audience:*** *Developers, Sales, Product Team*

Quick Snapshot

	MATA Matrimony	**Shaadi.com**	**BharatMatrimony**	**Jeevansathi**
Founded	2026	1997	2000	1996
Model	Partner-managed (B2B2C)	Direct-to-consumer	Direct-to-consumer	Direct-to-consumer
Target Market	Diaspora + Premium niche	Global Indian community	India-first	North India focus
Pricing	Partner-defined	$99–$1,095/yr	₹999–₹4,999 (~$12–$60)/mo	₹722–₹4,865 plan-based
Platform	Web (Next.js)	Web + App	Web + App	Web + App
API-first	✅ Yes — headless	❌ Monolithic	❌ Monolithic	❌ Monolithic
Photo Security	✅ Watermarked + SAS URLs	❌ No watermark	❌ No watermark	❌ No watermark
Data Breach History	✅ None (new)	⚠️ Reported incidents	❌ 2020 SQL injection breach	⚠️ Reported incidents

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Feature Comparison Matrix

Core Matchmaking Features

Feature	**MATA**	**Shaadi.com**	**BharatMatrimony**	**Jeevansathi**
Profile creation	✅	✅	✅	✅
Advanced search filters	✅	✅	✅	✅
Partner preferences	✅	✅	✅	✅
Favourites / Shortlist	✅	✅	✅	✅
Profile view tracking	✅	✅	✅	✅
Recommendations	✅	✅	✅	✅
Hobbies & interests	✅	⚠️ Limited	⚠️ Limited	❌

Profile completion score	✅	❌	❌	❌
Multi-profile per account	✅	❌	❌	❌
Multiple sections (education, employment, property, family)	✅ All	✅ Most	✅ Most	⚠️ Basic

Photo Management

Feature	**MATA**	**Shaadi.com**	**BharatMatrimony**	**Jeevansathi**
Max photos	**7 (categorised)**	20+	20+	20+
Photo categories / slots	✅ Named slots (Headshot, Full-body, Casual, Family, Candid, Hobby, Other)	❌ Generic gallery	❌ Generic gallery	❌ Generic gallery
Watermark on photos	✅ Auto-applied	❌	❌	❌
Time-limited SAS URLs	✅ (Azure — 1hr expiry)	❌ Permanent CDN URL	❌ Permanent CDN URL	❌ Permanent CDN URL
Thumbnail generation	✅ Auto	⚠️ Manual resize	⚠️ Manual resize	⚠️ Manual resize
Format normalisation (PNG→JPEG)	✅	❌	❌	❌
Cloud storage	✅ Azure Blob Storage	AWS S3/CDN	AWS/CDN	AWS/CDN
Photo replacement (same category)	✅	❌ (re-upload)	❌ (re-upload)	❌ (re-upload)

Security & Authentication

Feature	**MATA**	**Shaadi.com**	**BharatMatrimony**	**Jeevansathi**
OTP login (2FA)	✅ Required	⚠️ Optional	⚠️ Optional	⚠️ Optional
JWT-based sessions	✅	✅	✅	✅
API Key per client	✅ (every request)	❌	❌	❌
Rate limiting on auth	✅	⚠️ Basic	⚠️ Basic	⚠️ Basic
HttpOnly cookies for session	✅	❌	❌	❌

Password strength policy enforced	✅ (8+ chars, upper, lower, number, special)	❌ Weak	❌ Weak	❌ Weak
Photo URL expiry (prevents hotlinking)	✅ (1-hour SAS)	❌	❌	❌
Known data breach	✅ None	⚠️ Incidents reported	❌ 2020 breach (SQL injection, 1M+ records)	⚠️ Incidents reported

Architecture & Technical

Feature	**MATA**	**Shaadi.com**	**BharatMatrimony**	**Jeevansathi**
API-first / headless	✅	❌	❌	❌
Partner admin portal (B2B)	✅ (ekam-admin-api)	❌	❌	❌
Stored procedure data layer	✅ (audit log on every operation)	❌	❌	❌
Activity logging on all DB ops	✅	❌	❌	❌
Serverless deployment	✅ (Vercel)	❌ Traditional servers	❌ Traditional servers	❌ Traditional servers
Swagger / OpenAPI documented	✅	❌	❌	❌

Payments

Feature	**MATA**	**Shaadi.com**	**BharatMatrimony**	**Jeevansathi**
Online payments	✅ Stripe Checkout	✅ Razorpay/CC	✅ Razorpay/CC	✅ Various
Subscription model	✅	✅ Tiered (Silver-Platinum+)	✅ Tiered (Gold-Platinum)	✅ Tiered (Pro-Pro Supreme)
Webhook-authoritative payment	✅	⚠️	⚠️	⚠️

Communication

Feature	**MATA**	**Shaadi.com**	**BharatMatrimony**	**Jeevansathi**
In-app messaging	⬜ Roadmap	✅ (paid)	✅ (paid)	✅ (paid)
Video calls	⬜ Roadmap	✅ (Shaadi Live)	✅ (paid)	✅ (paid)

Voice messaging	⬜ Roadmap	❌	✅ (paid)	✅ (Pro plans)
Mobile app	⬜ Roadmap	✅ iOS + Android	✅ iOS + Android	✅ iOS + Android

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MATA's Key Differentiators (Win Themes)

🔐 1. Security-First Architecture

> *"Your photos are protected. Your data is safe."*

- **Watermarked photos** — every photo has "MataMatrimony" stamped before storage. Photos cannot be saved and reused on other platforms without attribution.
- **Time-limited photo URLs** — Azure SAS tokens expire after 1 hour. Photo links shared outside the platform become invalid, preventing hotlinking and scraping.
- **OTP mandatory** — every login requires a 6-digit OTP to the registered email. No session without 2FA.
- **API Key per client** — no API endpoint can be called without a valid client key. Prevents unauthorized access even if JWT tokens leak.
- **No known breach history** — BharatMatrimony suffered a major SQL injection breach in 2020 exposing 1M+ records. MATA's stored-procedure data layer provides a structured, parameterised barrier against SQL injection.

👫 2. Multi-Profile Per Account

> *"Register yourself, your sibling, or your child — one account, multiple profiles."*

Shaadi, BharatMatrimony, and Jeevansathi support only **one profile per account**. MATA allows a single account to manage **multiple profiles** — ideal for family members helping their relatives find a match, or matrimony agencies managing client profiles.

📸 3. Structured Photo Gallery (Categorised Slots)

> *"Tell your story, not just show your face."*

Competitors offer a generic photo gallery. MATA's 7 **named photo slots** guide users to present themselves holistically:

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1. Clear Headshot      — Primary profile photo
2. Full-body shot      — Full length photo
3. Casual/Lifestyle    — You in your element
4. Family Photo        — With your family
5. Candid/Fun Moment   — A natural, happy moment
6. Hobby/Activity      — Doing what you love
7. Other               — Any other photo
```

This structured approach gives match-seekers a **richer, more authentic view** of the person — not just a posed profile picture.

🏢 4. Partner (Agency) Management — B2B2C Model

> *"Power matrimony agencies with your own branded platform."*

Unlike Shaadi/BharatMatrimony which are direct-to-consumer, MATA operates as a **B2B2C platform**:

- **Partner Admin API** (`ekam-admin-api`) allows registered matrimony agencies to manage profiles, photos, and members on behalf of clients
- Agencies get their own admin portal with full profile CRUD capabilities
- Partner-specific data isolation (`partner_id` scoping on all blobs and data)

This B2B2C model creates **stickier enterprise relationships** and expands reach through established agency networks.

📊 5. Profile Completion Tracking

> *"Know exactly what's missing — and fill it."*

MATA exposes a profile completion percentage (`/profile/profile-completion/:profile_id`) broken down by section. Users see exactly which tabs are incomplete. Competitors do not expose a structured completion score — users are left guessing why they are not getting matches.

🔧 6. API-First, Headless Architecture

> *"Built for the future. Easy to integrate and extend."*

- All features exposed as documented REST APIs (Swagger)
- UI is fully decoupled from the API → easy to build mobile apps later
- Stored procedure data layer enforces business rules at the DB level (photo limits, validation, audit logging)
- Fully serverless on Vercel → scales automatically, zero infrastructure management

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Common Competitor Weaknesses to Call Out

Weakness	Shaadi.com	BharatMatrimony	Jeevansathi
Data breach history	⚠️ Reported	❌ 2020 SQL injection breach	⚠️ Reported
Permanent photo URLs (can be scraped/hotlinked)	❌ Yes	❌ Yes	❌ Yes
Photos can be downloaded and misused	❌ No watermark	❌ No watermark	❌ No watermark
Single profile per account	❌ Yes	❌ Yes	❌ Yes
Opaque privacy policies	❌ Generic	❌ Generic	❌ Generic
No B2B partner portal	❌	❌	❌
Generic photo gallery (no categories)	❌	❌	❌
Aggressive upsell / freemium gate	❌ Many features paywalled	❌ Very limited free tier	❌ Limited free tier

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Objection Handling

Objection	Response
"Shaadi.com has millions of users."	**MATA is B2B2C.** We grow through partner agencies who bring their existing client bases — not by competing head-to-head in consumer advertising.
"BharatMatrimony has a mobile app."	**True — mobile app is on the roadmap.** Because we are API-first, the app is a UI layer away. We can ship it without any backend changes.
"Established platforms have horoscope matching."	**Planned for V1.1.** Our lookup table and stored procedure architecture make adding new profile sections very low-effort.
"Users won't trust a new platform."	**Our security posture is stronger from Day 1.** BharatMatrimony suffered a 1M+ record breach. We launched with mandatory 2FA, photo watermarking, time-limited URLs, and parameterised stored procedures.
"Competitors have video calls."	**In-app messaging and video are on our roadmap.** We chose to get the core profile and photo experience right first — the foundation competitors skipped and later patched.

Roadmap (V1.1 and Beyond)

Feature	Priority	Status
Mobile App (React Native)	High	☐ Roadmap
In-app Messaging	High	☐ Roadmap
Video Calls	Medium	☐ Roadmap
Horoscope / Astro Match	Medium	☐ Roadmap
AI-based Match Recommendations	Medium	☐ Roadmap
Profile Verification / KYC	High	☐ Roadmap
Push Notifications	Medium	☐ Roadmap
Assisted Matchmaking (Relationship Manager)	Low	☐ Roadmap

Summary: Why MATA Wins

Scenario	MATA Advantage
Agency wants to offer matrimony services	Only MATA has a Partner Admin system
User worried about photo misuse	Only MATA watermarks photos + uses expiring URLs
User has multiple family members to register	Only MATA supports multi-profile per account
Enterprise buyer evaluating security	Only MATA has mandatory 2FA, API keys, SP-based data layer

Technical evaluator reviewing architecture	Only MATA is API-first, Swagger-documented, serverless
User wants structured, authentic photo presentation	Only MATA has 7 structured, named photo categories

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Document maintained in `Docs/battle-card.md`. Update roadmap section when features ship.